

European diesel release may be only way to avoid US export restrictions

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The US's request for Europe to release Diesel emergency stocks may be the last option to avoid US export restrictions. Brazil's Luiz Inacio Lula da Si|||||||

Daily Brief

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summary

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The US's request for Europe to release Diesel emergency stocks may be the last option to avoid US export restrictions.

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Brazil's Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva and Flavio Bolsonaro would diverge the most on oil and gas, mining, climate and technology policies.

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The US and Nigeria's critical minerals framework will deepen Africa's role in critical minerals supply.

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The EU's critical minerals strategy will leave it behind its major competitors.

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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, Brazil, the EU, Nigeria, Lebanon, geo-technology, energy, and resources.

the top line

EU, US, energy—European diesel release may be last offramp to avoid US export curb

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The US has asked European countries to release about 120 million barrels of diesel from emergency stocks over six months or face US diesel export restrictions, which appears likely to avoid US export curbs.

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If Europe does not act to release stockpiles by the middle of next week, and US retail prices reverse their recent declines, then we would revise our current odds of a US refined products export restriction upward (currently 40%).

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If European leaders appear unwilling to release stocks or move to release only a portion of the volume requested following a reported meeting tomorrow morning, the US would weigh a partial restriction to cap US exports nearer to prewar volumes.

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The requested EU release would offset only about 40% of the shortfall; a full US export ban would nearly double it, though we expect any US restriction to affect about 500,000 bpd.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net .

Goeconomics, France—Chart of the day

Brazil— Lula and Bolsonaro would diverge sharply on key regulated sectors

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A fourth Lula term would bring modest fiscal tightening, sectoral policy that mixes incentives for private investments with a larger role for the state, and a largely unchanged team.

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A Flavio Bolsonaro administration would deliver a deeper fiscal adjustment and lighter regulation as it courts private sector investment across sectors.

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Oil and gas, mining, climate, and technology policy would diverge most sharply between the two, while electricity, biofuels, and infrastructure concessions would see more continuity (see detailed policy reports and a stakeholder map here).

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

Nigeria—US-Nigeria framework deepens Africa's role in mineral supply chains

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Nigeria and the US signed a critical minerals framework in New York. Following the agreement, Nigerian miner Promethean Resources signed deals with US companies Vermeer Corporation and Renewvia Energy to supply mining equipment and energy solutions.

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President Bola Tinubu has made solid minerals a policy priority, appointing close adviser Dele Alake as minister and sharply increasing the ministry's budget. Alake has since pursued reforms to formalize artisanal mining and strengthen security at mining sites, while seeking to capitalize on rising global demand and geopolitical competition for minerals that the US has designated as critical.

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Officials report that mining royalties and licensing revenue have more than doubled, while federation receipts have risen by over 300% since 2023. That success will likely encourage the government to focus on attracting technology, financing, and offtake partners to the sector.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: africa@eurasiagroup.net .

EU, Resources—EU critical minerals strategy will continue to lag behind competitors

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The EU's Critical Raw Materials Act is moving too slowly and related funding is dwarfed by other powers like the US, China, and Japan, deterring private sector involvement.

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Some of the major extractive, refining, and recycling projects that Europe is envisioning both inside the EU and abroad will be partially cannibalized by competitor consumers—particularly the US and Japan—unless Europe promotes sustainable internal demand for them through more tangible public support.

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Improving market conditions, such as higher demand and lower energy prices, will help, but the minerals market has grown accustomed to aggressive industrial policy that Europe has yet to match.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: europe@eurasiagroup.net .

US—White House AI accord leaves labs exposed to regulators

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US AI labs have committed to four AI safety control layers (monitoring, internal verification, external audit, oversight) in the White House Accord on Super Intelligence, but the controls are largely already in place, and none delay or stop a model release.

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The requirement that models not hack or access technical systems in unintended ways exposes labs to existing scrutiny, including a weeks-old Federal Trade Commission investigation, but does not impose new liability, reporting or regulatory obligations, or federal oversight.

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The accord does not shield the labs from existing consumer protection or antitrust authorities, leaving them as exposed to enforcement as they were before the signing.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: geo-technology@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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4 October 9:00 PM ET—Brazil update: Election night. Register here .

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5 October 8:00 AM ET—Brazil update (In English). Register here .

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5 October 9:30 AM ET—Brazil update (In Portuguese). Register here .

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7 October 10:00 AM ET—Mexico update. Register here .

eg in brief

Brazil—Most frequently asked questions before the first round: Lula's first-round lead over Bolsonaro will likely narrow to just one to two points as strategic voting kicks in before the vote. Investors will probably overstate how much a narrow margin makes Bolsonaro the clear favorite in a runoff, as the race remains close to a toss-up. EG's 55% odds in favor of Lula are currently under review after he lost his polling momentum mid-week. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

Lebanon—Banking reforms challenged, IMF deal pushed beyond 2026: Lebanese President Joseph Aoun has lodged an appeal with the Constitutional Council challenging Article 3 of the Bank Restructuring Law, a central element of Beirut's efforts to get IMF aid to stabilize the country's economy and finances following the Israel-Hezbollah war. The review process could take up to eight months to even start, though an aid to the Lebanese president has claimed the process could be finalized within one month. If the law is struck down, it will have to go back to parliament, where likely lengthy negotiations will commence. Meanwhile, lobbying by commercial banks and political wrangling have cast doubt over the prospects for the Gap Law, formally known as the Financial Stability and Deposit Recovery law, meant to allocate an estimated \$81 billion in losses stemming from the country's 2019 economic collapse. The two pieces of legislation and the medium-term fiscal framework are the key requirements for a full-fledged agreement with the IMF. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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3 October: Events: Latvia parliamentary elections; Data: Vietnam trade and industrial production.

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4 October: Events: Brazil first round of presidential elections.

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5 October: Data: Eurozone PPI.

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6 October: Data: US trade.

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7 October: Data: China foreign reserves; Central bank decisions: Peru and Poland.

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8 October: Data: Japan current account balance, Taiwan trade; Central bank decisions: Romania and Uruguay.

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9 October: Data: Brazil and Russia CPI, and US UMich consumer sentiment.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, Blaise Hanson, and Trista Kelley.

closing quip

"We may do that. They have some diesel."—US President Donald Trump said yesterday regarding Europe releasing diesel stocks.

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